

THE QURIO

MAGAZINE

Small Actions, Big Change



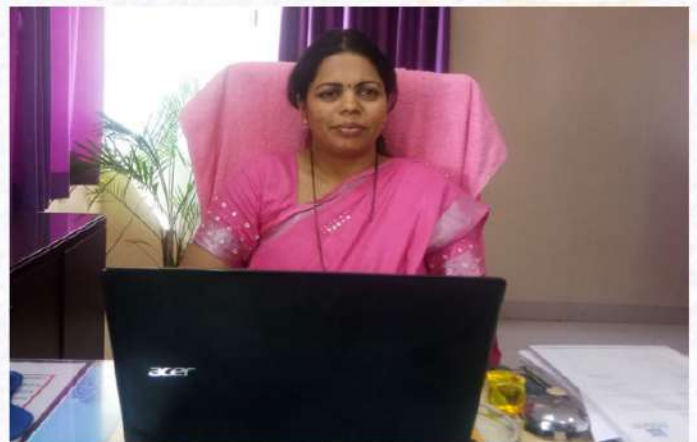
Volume 1 | 2026 - 27
PIS - Washim

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FROM THE PRINCIPAL'S DESK



Dear Students and Parents, At the outset, I would like to express my heartfelt gratitude to the parents and families who have entrusted us with the responsibility of educating their children. This trust is both an honour and a duty - one we strive every day to uphold with sincerity and dedication. In today's dynamic world, the role of education extends beyond the boundaries of textbooks. Our aim is to nurture young minds into confident, compassionate, and curious learners - ready to embrace the challenges of life and the opportunities of tomorrow. Our school endeavours to create a balanced environment that blends academic rigour with a wide spectrum of co-scholastic activities to shape well-rounded individuals. This edition of our school magazine is a testament to our students' creative spirit. Titled "Small Actions, Big Change", the theme is about Change, which doesn't always arrive with a roar - sometimes it begins with a whisper. A single kind word, one small effort, a quiet decision to do things differently - these are the sparks that set bigger changes into motion. This edition of our magazine explores that very idea: how small actions, often unnoticed in the moment, can ripple outward to create impact far greater than their size suggests. Through stories, art, and voices from our own community, we celebrate the power of originality of our young contributors will leave every reader enriched and inspired. "Education is a shared commitment between dedicated teachers, motivated students and enthusiastic parents with high expectations."

Warm regards,

Mrs. Arti Domkulwar Mam

Principal

**Podar International School, Washim
2026-27**

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DID YOU KNOW?

► The Science of small things

Tiny causes. Huge effects. Here's how the smallest things in life quietly shape everything around us.

A. WHY DO HABITS FORM?

Every habit like biting your nails, checking your phone, brushing your teeth before bed follows the same tiny loop inside your brain:

- ~ **a Cue** (*something that starts it*),
- ~ **a Routine** (*the action you do*), and
- ~ **a Reward** (*something that feels good*).

Do this loop enough times, and your brain stops thinking about it altogether. It becomes automatic, running quietly in the background like a well-worn path through a field.

Did you know?

Scientists believe habits are stored in a part of the brain called the basal ganglia — the same region active in animals as simple as sea slugs!

C. THE DOMINO EFFECT

Line up enough dominoes and tip just the first one the rest fall in a chain reaction, one after another.

The domino effect describes any situation where a single small event triggers a whole series of similar events, like a row of falling tiles. It's used to describe everything from history (one event sparking a chain of others) to everyday life (one late bus making you miss your whole morning).

Did you know?

A domino can knock over another domino about 1.5 times its own size. Line up dominoes that each grow by that much, and just 29 of them could topple something as tall as the Empire State Building!

B. THE BUTTERFLY EFFECT

This idea comes from chaos theory and asks a wonderfully strange question:

Could the flap of a butterfly's wings in Brazil set off a tornado in Texas?

Of course, one flap doesn't cause a tornado but it shows how tiny, almost invisible changes at the start of a system can grow and grow until they lead to something huge and totally unpredictable.

Did you know?

The term was coined by meteorologist Edward Lorenz in the 1960s, after he found that a tiny rounding change in his weather computer model completely changed the forecast!

D. THE RIPPLE EFFECT

Drop a single pebble into a still pond and watch what happens:

Circles of water spread outward, farther and farther, long after the pebble has sunk. The ripple effect works the same way with our actions one small act, like a kind word or a smile, can spread outward and influence people far beyond the person it was first given to.

Did you know?

Researchers have found that kindness can spread through social networks up to three degrees away meaning your good deed could reach a friend, of a friend, of a friend, without you ever knowing it!

Small Actions, Big Ripples



You don't need to change the world all at once. Try one of these small actions this week and see where the ripple goes.

Plant a Seed



Push one seed into soil today. Given a few years, it could be a tree giving shade, fruit, or clean air to a whole street.

Say Thank You



A genuine "thank you" costs nothing, but it can brighten someone's whole day — and make them kinder to the next person too.

Pick Up One Piece of Litter



You don't need to clean a whole beach. One piece of rubbish in the bin instead of on the ground stops a small problem from growing.

Turn Off a Light



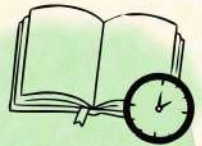
Flicking off a switch when you leave a room takes one second — but done every day for a year, it saves real energy.

Share a Smile



A smile is contagious. Scientists have shown it can pass from face to face across a whole room, without a single word.

Read for 10 Minutes



Ten minutes a day doesn't feel like much — but over a year, that's more than 60 hours of reading. Dozens of books, one page at a time.

Save a Drop of Water



Turning off the tap while you brush your teeth can save several litres of clean water — every single day.

Hold the Door



Holding a door for the person behind you takes two seconds — and often inspires them to do the very same for someone else.

Pick just one. Do it today. Then watch how far it travels.



A Verse of Change

Poems on - 'A small good deed...'

One small change, Making a Big Difference.

A SPARK CAN GLOW UP A NIGHT,
AND A CANDLE CAN BRING US LIGHT.
A LITTLE CHANGE IN WHAT WE DO
CAN MAKE A FUTURE BRIGHT.
ONE TINY STEP, ONE THOUGHTFUL CHOICE,
ONE MOMENT TO BEGIN,
CAN TURN A WORLD OF DOUBT AND FEAR
INTO A WORLD THAT WINS.

A SINGLE SEED MAY SEEM SO SMALL,
YET ONE DAY IT CAN STAND SO TALL,
IT GROWS THROUGH RAIN, THROUGH WIND,
THROUGH SUN,
UNTIL ITS JOURNEY IS FINALLY WON.
JUST LIKE THAT SEED, OUR CHOICES GROW,
AND SHAPE THE WORLD WE WANT TO KNOW,
A LITTLE COURAGE, A LITTLE CARE,
CAN SPREAD A MESSAGE EVERYWHERE.

SOMEVER SAY, "MY CHANGE IS SMALL.
IT CANNOT MAKE A DIFFERENCE AT ALL."
FOR EVERY RIVER STARTS WITH A STREAM,
AND EVERY ACHIEVEMENT STARTS WITH A DREAM.
THE GREATEST CHANGES WE CAN SEE
BEGIN WITH YOU, AND BEGIN WITH ME,
ONE BETTER CHOICE, ONE STEP TODAY -
AND LITTLE BY LITTLE, WE CHANGE THE WAY.

- Written By :

Shambhuraje J Gawali (7th Lily)



A Verse of Change

Poems on - 'A small good deed...'

A Single Match!



A SINGLE MATCH CAN LIGHT THE DARK,
A FOREST RISES FROM A SPARK,
A POCKET CLEARED OF PLASTIC WASTE,
KEEPS RIVER CLEAN AND UN-ERASED.

A SEAT GIVEN UP UPON A TRAIN,
AN OPEN DOOR THROUGH WIND AND RAIN,
A STEADY HAND TO HELP ONE RISE,
CAN BRING THE COURAGE TO THEIR EYES.

THE WORLD WON'T SHIFT WITH WORDS
ALONE,
IT MOVES EACH TIME WE TURN A STONE,
NO GENTLE DEED IS CAST IN VAIN—
ONE FALLING DROP BEGINS THE RAIN..

- Written By :

Stavya Jayprakash Kandoi



When my brush speaks...

A page on artistic expression that depicts the theme - Small actions, big change...



BY : VEDIKA WANI (4TH LILY)

The Butterfly Effect

In Real Life: One Man, One Forest

How a teenage boy planting a few bamboo shoots on a bare Indian sandbar grew into a 1,360-acre forest home to tigers, rhinos, and elephants.



The Problem: A River, a Flood, and a Graveyard of Snakes.

In 1979, on Majuli, the world's largest river island, in the Brahmaputra River in Assam, India a huge flood swept through and left the land behind it bare and sandy. Soon after, a 16-year-old boy named Jadav Payeng came across something that broke his heart: hundreds of snakes, washed onto the empty sandbar by the flood, lying dead in the scorching sun. With no trees and no shade to protect them, they simply couldn't survive the heat.



The Tiny Action: 20 Bamboo Seedlings

Jadav asked the local forest department for help planting trees on the sandbar. They told him nothing could grow in such poor, sandy soil, but said he could try planting bamboo. So that is exactly what he did. Jadav planted just 20 bamboo seedlings by himself, then kept coming back, day after day, to water them and care for them. Nobody asked him to. Nobody paid him to. He just kept going.

Jadav didn't stop at bamboo he began collecting seeds and saplings of other trees too, planting a little more of the forest with his own hands almost every single day for over 40 years.

The Ripple Grows: From Sandbar to Forest

As the bamboo took root, it slowly changed the sandbar itself trapping soil, holding moisture, and creating the right conditions for other plants to grow. Jadav kept adding more trees: cotton trees, arjun, and many native Assamese species. Over decades, one man's quiet daily habit transformed a lifeless sandbank into a genuine forest, complete with its own soil, shade, and ecosystem all without machines, without a team, and almost entirely alone.



The Surprise Discovery

For nearly 30 years, almost nobody outside Jadav's village knew what he had done. Then in 2008, forest officials went looking for a herd of wild elephants that had wandered off after damaging a nearby village and found them sheltering inside a dense forest that, according to their own maps, should not have existed at all. That "undiscovered" forest was Molai Forest named after Jadav's nickname, "Molai."



Did you know?

Today, Molai Forest is bigger than New York City's Central Park, and is home to Bengal tigers, Indian rhinoceroses, deer, over 100 elephants that visit each year, and hundreds of species of birds.

Why This Is the Butterfly Effect

Jadav Payeng didn't set out to create a 1,360-acre forest he just wanted to save some snakes from the sun. But that single small decision, repeated quietly every day for over 40 years, set off a chain of changes far too large for anyone to have predicted: soil formed, plants spread, animals returned, and an entire ecosystem came to life. In 2015, Jadav was awarded the Padma Shri one of India's highest civilian honours and is now known around the world as the "Forest Man of India."

"I'll plant till my last breath." — Jadav "Molai" Payeng

It started with one...



Write about a true event or a story of 'How a small action by someone created a big impact...



The Empty Chair



The Day Nothing Special Happened!

THERE WAS AN EMPTY CHAIR IN OUR CLASSROOM. EVERY MORNING, STUDENTS GATHERED IN GROUPS, TALKED, LAUGHED AND SHARED STORIES. BUT ONE BOY ALMOST ALWAYS SAT ALONE. NOBODY DISLIKED HIM. NOBODY WAS CRUEL TO HIM. WE HAD SIMPLY STOPPED NOTICING HIM



ONE MORNING, I SAW HIM SITTING ALONE AGAIN. I THOUGHT ABOUT GOING OVER.

MAYBE TOMORROW.

BUT INSTEAD OF WALKING

PAST, I PICKED UP MY CHAIR, CARRIED IT ACROSS THE ROOM AND ASKED: "CAN I SIT HERE?" HE LOOKED SURPRISED.

THEN HE SMILED. "YES." THAT WAS IT.

NO APPLAUSE. NO ANNOUNCEMENT. NO GREAT SPEECH.

JUST ONE CHAIR MOVING A FEW FEET.

AT THE TIME, I DIDN'T KNOW IT WOULD MATTER..

THE CHAIR MOVED. SOMETHING ELSE DID TOO.

THE NEXT DAY, WE SAT TOGETHER AGAIN.

A CONVERSATION STARTED. SOMEONE ELSE JOINED. THEN ANOTHER.

THE BOY WHO ONCE SPENT BREAKS QUIETLY AT HIS DESK BEGAN TALKING AND LAUGHING. HE BECAME PART OF CONVERSATIONS THAT HAD ONCE HAPPENED WITHOUT HIM. NOTHING DRAMATIC HAD HAPPENED. AND YET, SOMETHING HAD CHANGED. NOT JUST FOR HIM.

FOR US. WE STARTED NOTICING THE STUDENTS WHO STOOD AT THE EDGE OF GROUPS—THE ONES WHO DIDN'T SPEAK FIRST, THE ONES WAITING FOR SOMEONE ELSE TO INVITE THEM. NOTHING DRAMATIC HAD HAPPENED. YET, SOMETHING HAD CHANGED. ONE CHAIR HAD BECOME AN INVITATION. ONE INVITATION HAD BECOME A HABIT. WE BEGAN NOTICING THOSE AT THE EDGES—AND MAKING SPACE FOR THEM. BECAUSE SOMETIMES, CHANGE BEGINS WITH SOMETHING AS SIMPLE AS MOVING YOUR CHAIR.

Who was the person?

One Of The New Student

What was the action?

Moved my chair and asked him, "Can I sit here?" As he Was sitting all alone

What was the impact?

It helped him feel included, and others began including people too.



Written By - Somesh Anil Bali (9th Rose)

A time I made a small change...

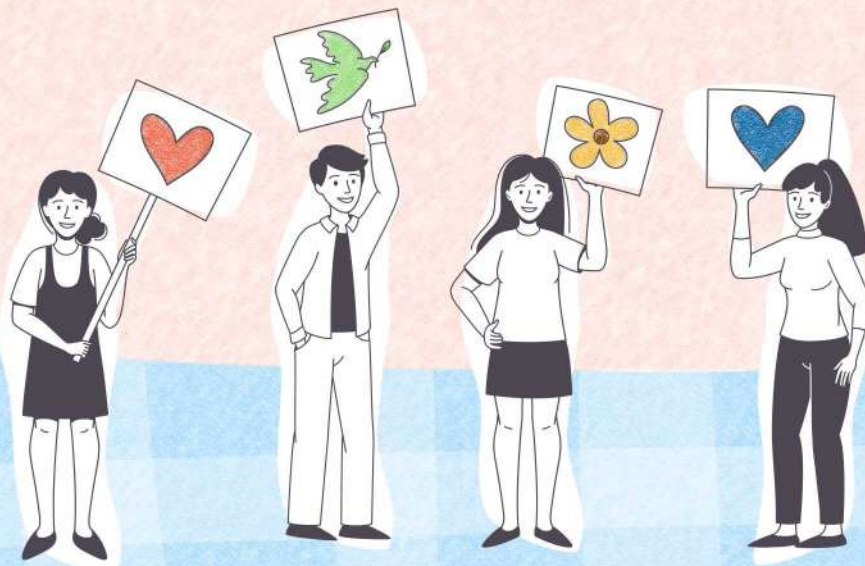
**“One Small action created
a big impact”**

ONE DAY A LITTLE GIRL NAMED BHAVI WAS WALKING HOME FROM SCHOOL. SHE NOTICED A TINY PLANT GROWING BESIDE THE ROAD. THE PLANT LOOKED WEAK AND DRY, SO BHAVI DECIDED TO HELP. EVERY DAY, SHE CARRIED A SMALL BOTTLE OF WATER FROM HER HOME. SHE CAREFULLY WATERED THE PLANT AND REMOVED THE WEEDS AROUND IT. AT FIRST NOBODY PAID ATTENTION TO HER. AFTER A FEW DAYS, THE PLANT BEGAN TO GROW BEAUTIFULLY. BHAVI'S FRIENDS NOTICED HER WORK AND DECIDED TO HELP HER. SOON, MANY CHILDREN JOINED BHAVI IN PLANTING AND CARING FOR TREES. THE STREET SLOWLY BECAME GREEN, CLEAN AND BEAUTIFUL.

THE NEIGHBOURS APPRECIATED THE CHILDREN'S EFFORTS. BHAVI FELT PROUD AND HAPPY TO SEE THE CHANGE. HER SMALL ACTION HAD INSPIRED THE WHOLE NEIGHBOURHOOD.

Moral : Small actions can bring big changes.

Written By : Shravani Gajanan Lade (8th Rose)



This clicked for me!

Original photographs of small actions that you think is important -
Write captions to convey the thought behind the picture.



**A Little Smile , A Little Care , A Helping Hand , We All Can
Share Plant A Tree , Keep Earth Clean , Be Kind And Good ,
Make Our World Green.!**

**A SMALL INITIATIVE WITH A BIG CHANGE AND HELP FOR
ENVIRONMENT BY OUR STUDENTS :**

- 1)SWAROOP SANJAY KALE (1ST LILY)**
- 2) SHARVIKA SANTOSH KALE (1ST LILY)**



This clicked for me!

Original photographs of small actions that you think is important -
Write captions to convey the thought behind the picture.



A Sapling Planted By Our Student :



A Story in Panels

A comic strip storyboard that shows a short incident of a small action and its impact.

1. It was just another day at school. During a maths test, my classmate Rohan looked stressed. He hadn't brought his geometry box.



2. I quickly shared my geometry box with him. It was a small thing — just a little help.



3. After the test, Rohan came to me with a smile. He said he had done well and felt much calmer.



4. A few months later, Rohan started improving in studies. He became more confident, joined the school football team and even helped other students.



5. Today, Rohan is not just a good student — he's a leader, confident and kind. He often reminds others to help and support each other.

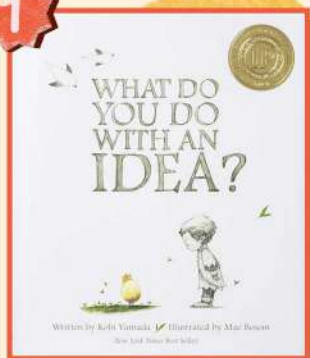


6. That small act of sharing turned into a friendship, a growth story, and a reminder that every small action matters.

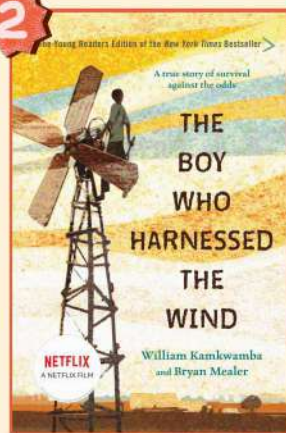


Book Recommendations

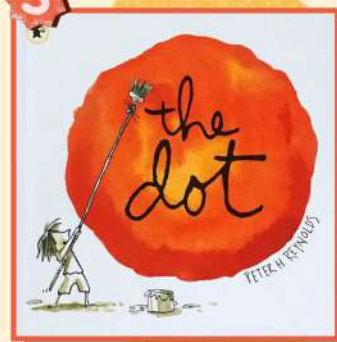
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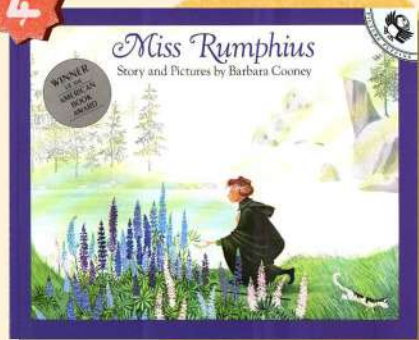
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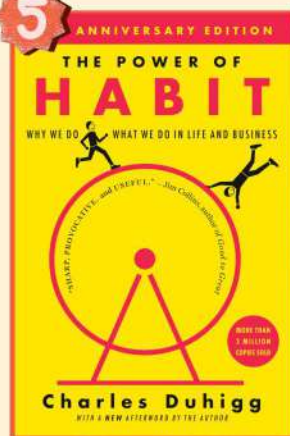
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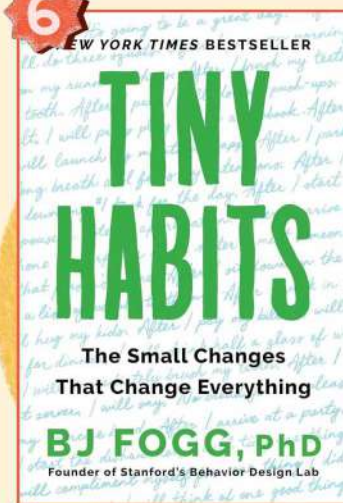
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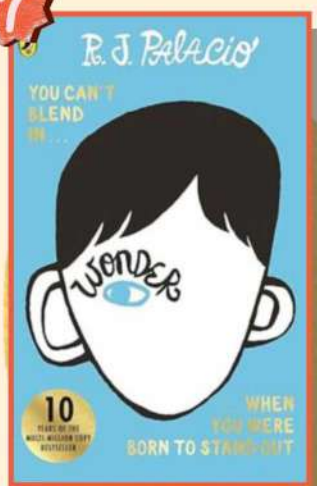
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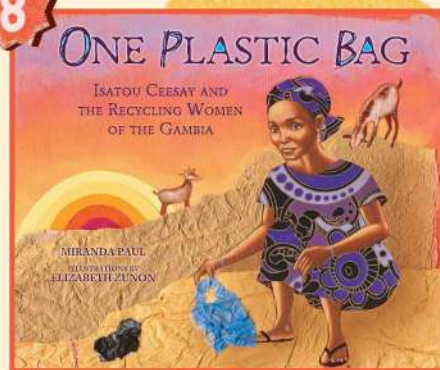
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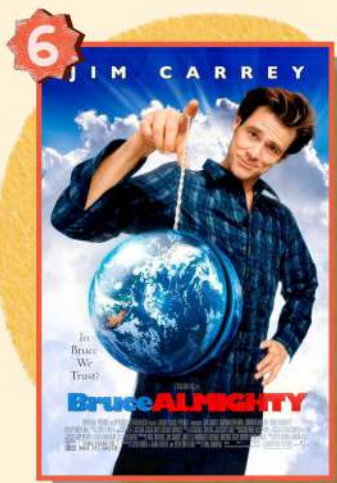
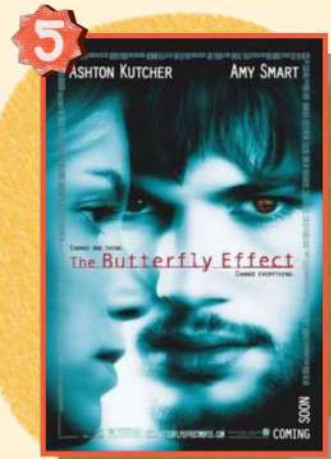
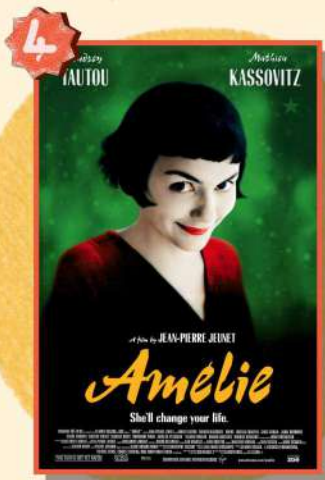
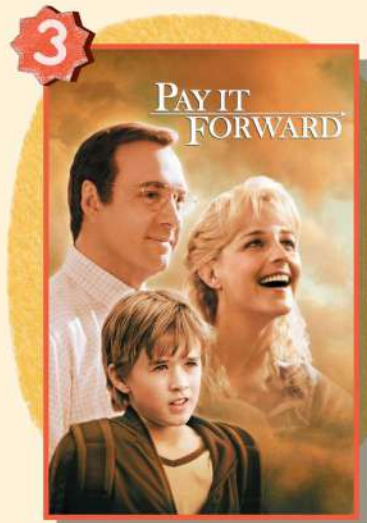
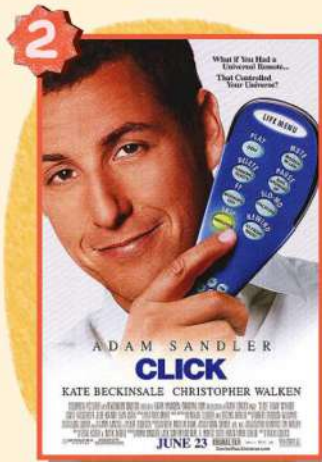
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8



Movie Recommendations



Review

Books & Movies

Title of the Movie/Book:

**IKIGAI: THE JAPANESE
SECRET TO A LONG AND
HAPPY LIFE**

Movie/Book Reviewed By:

**SWAROOP KAILAS
BODKHE (9TH LILY)**

Movie/Book Summary:

Ikigai by Héctor García and Francesc Miralles explores the Japanese concept of ikigai, meaning a reason or purpose for living. The book explains how finding purpose, staying active, building meaningful relationships, enjoying simple things, and maintaining a healthy lifestyle can contribute to a fulfilling life. Through ideas inspired by Japanese traditions and the lives of long-living people in Okinawa, the authors encourage readers to discover what gives their life meaning and to take small, purposeful steps every day.

How many hearts will
you give to this
movie/book?

(Colouring 1 heart means
the movie/book was
really bad. Colouring 5
hearts means it was
great!)

Title of the Movie/Book:

Movie/Book Reviewed By:

Movie/Book Summary:

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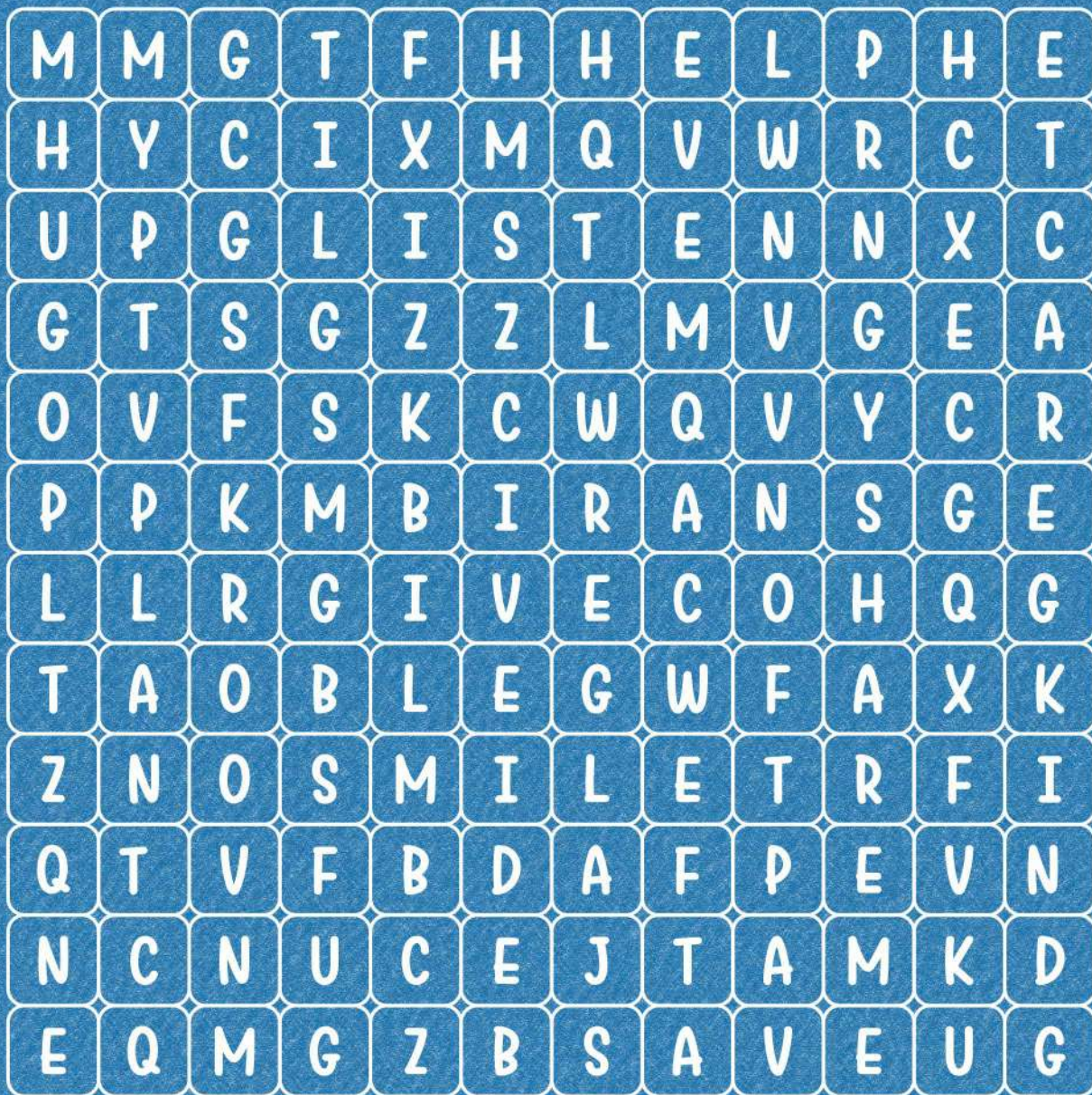
EVERYDAY

SUPERPOWERS



A WORD SEARCH OF EVERYDAY SUPERPOWERS

You don't need a cape to be a superhero. Find these everyday superpowers hidden in the grid below!



WORD BANK

SMILE

SHARE

LISTEN

HELP

PLANT

KIND

CARE

HUG

GIVE

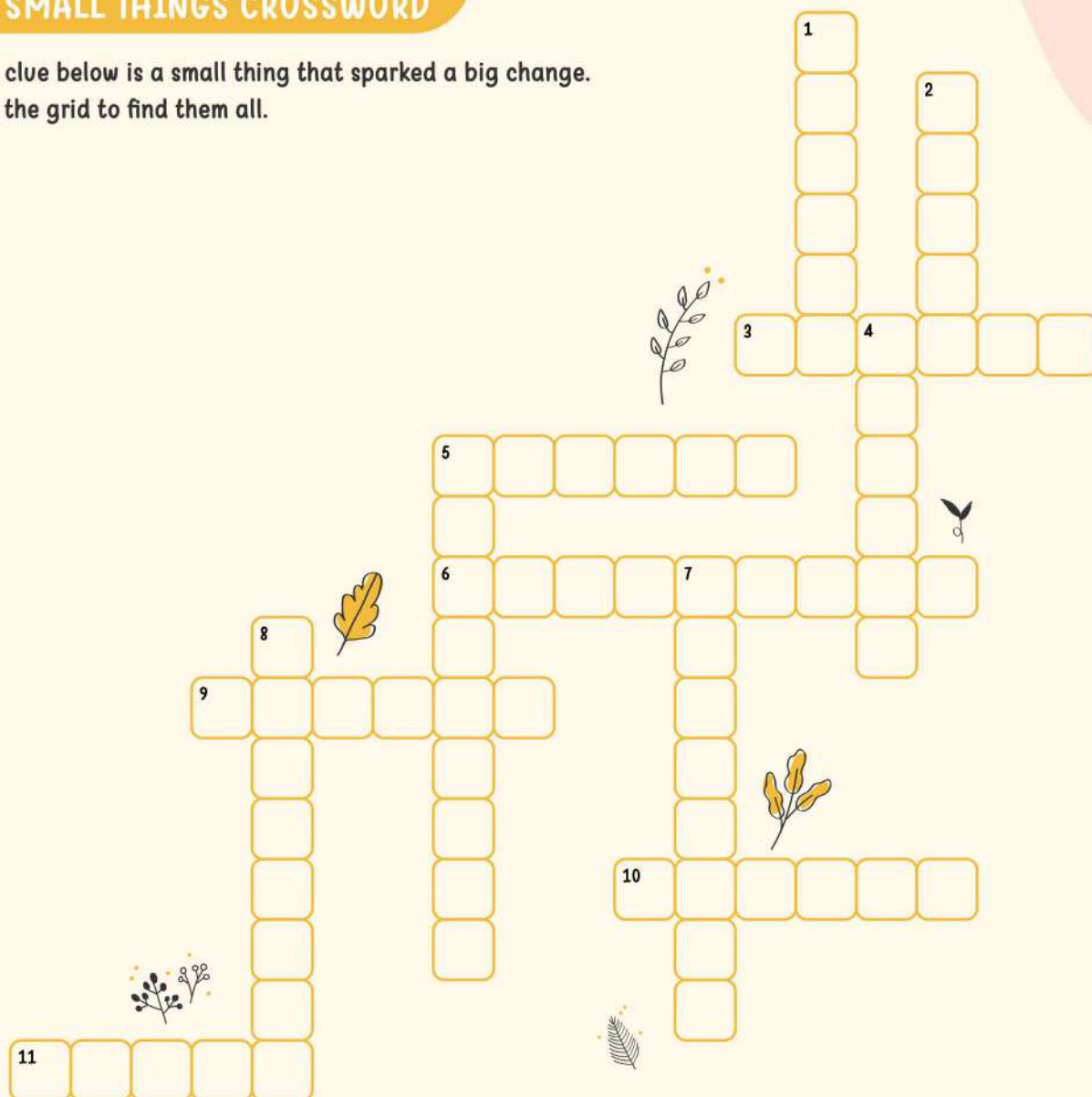
SAVE



CATALYSTS FOR CHANGE

THE SMALL THINGS CROSSWORD

Every clue below is a small thing that sparked a big change.
Fill in the grid to find them all.



ACROSS

3. The meteorologist whose weather model gave the Butterfly Effect its name.
5. The first plant Jadav Payeng planted on a barren river sandbar in Assam.
6. The point at which one more small change suddenly causes a large shift.
9. This Japanese philosophy is built on the idea of continuous, small improvements.
10. Surname of the real-life 'Forest Man of India' who single-handedly grew a huge forest.
11. A behaviour that becomes automatic after a cue-routine-reward loop repeats enough times.

DOWN

1. Tip just one of these tiles and watch a whole row fall in a chain reaction.
2. A gentle push that encourages a choice or change without forcing it.
4. The circular waves that spread outward after a pebble drops into still water.
5. A tiny insect used to describe how a small cause can lead to a huge, unpredictable effect.
7. An effect where something small keeps growing bigger and bigger as it rolls along.
8. A person or substance that triggers a big change without being used up itself.

CRACK THE CODE

A CATALYSTS FOR CHANGE CRYPTOGRAM

Every letter below has been swapped for another. Crack each code, one letter at a time, to reveal three famous lines about small acts and big change.

QUOTE 1

H B N L G B Y W A H K H M F F, H B

E N G G M V T B X F E N C C, A F

M Q M V X N F G M K.

QUOTE 1 KEY — fill in each letter as you crack it:

A	B	C	E	F	G	H	K	L	M	N	Q	T	V	W	X	Y	X	Y
I	O	L	M	S	T	N	D	C	E	A	V	H	R	K	W	F	W	F

QUOTE 2

R V G P P G M S R, C F J L

V A P S N U P N J W Q H V N P P N B L R

B E U J B U P J, M G L

S X G L R E B X V S F J C B X P W.

QUOTE 2 KEY — fill in each letter as you crack it:

A	B	C	E	F	G	H	J	L	M	N	P	Q	R	S	U	V	W	X
U	O	W	F	H	A	Y	E	N	C	I	L	B	S	T	P	M	D	R

QUOTE 3

J K W K N F U P G V V C Q V Q

L S Q H H R N U P I U E

V C U P R C V E P H, O U S S T V V K F

O T V T Y K J L O Q J O C Q J R K

V C K B U N H F.

QUOTE 3 KEY — fill in each letter as you crack it:

B	C	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	Y
W	H	F	D	B	L	P	N	E	S	R	C	U	A	G	M	I	O	T	V	Z

Spotlight @ PIS

The Conscious Closet - Culminating Event



Teachers Day Celebration - 2026



The Conscious Closet : Debate Competition



ANSWER KEY

CATALYSTS FOR CHANGE

THE SMALL THINGS CROSSWORD



CRACK THE CODE

A CATALYSTS FOR CHANGE CRYPTOGRAM

Quote 1 -

NO ACT OF KINDNESS NO MATTER HOW SMALL IS EVER WASTED.

Quote 2 -

SMALL ACTS WHEN MULTIPLIED BY MILLIONS OF PEOPLE CAN TRANSFORM THE WORLD.

Quote 3 -

NEVER DOUBT THAT A SMALL GROUP OF THOUGHTFUL, COMMITTED CITIZENS CAN CHANGE THE WORLD.



Podar International School , Washim



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